

Solomon Islands

Ratio: 5:9 **Adopted:** November 18, 1977 **Usage:** National and Civil

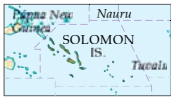
The five stars represent the five main groups of islands



Green represents the land

The yellow stripe symbolizes sunshine

Australasia and Oceania



The **Solomon Islands** were a British colony from 1883, until they became self-governing in 1976, and subsequently independent in 1978.

Before the current flag was adopted in 1977, three different coats of arms had represented the islands.

The national flag, adopted in 1977, is divided diagonally by a stripe of yellow representing the sunshine of the islands. The two triangles formed by the diagonal stripe are blue and green, signifying

water and the land. The five stars were initially incorporated to represent the country's five districts. The islands were later divided into seven districts and the symbolism of the stars was modified to refer to the five main groups of islands.

The coat of arms is also in the colors of the national flag.

ARMS OF THE SOLOMON ISLANDS

The crest is a traditional canoe (in section) and a shining sun

A freshwater crocodile

The national motto –
"To lead is to serve"



A shark

The shield depicts frigate birds, an eagle, two turtles, a shield and bow and arrow, all representing districts of the Solomon Islands

The compartment is a stylized frigate bird